



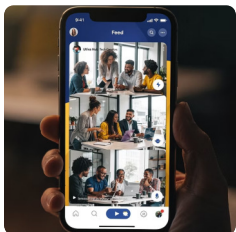
Module 1 Portfolio Assignment

From Task-Doer to Structured Professional

Imagine you just landed your first client. This assignment challenges you to prove — not just to them, but to yourself — that you can handle a client project with real professionalism from start to finish.

Your Task: Pick One Service

Choose **one service area** to build your portfolio project around. This becomes the foundation for every section you'll complete in this assignment.



Social Media Management

Content calendars, post creation, and engagement strategy for a client's brand.



Logo Design

Visual identity creation including concepts, revisions, and final deliverables.



Website Design

Planning and designing a functional, polished website for a client's business.



Content Writing

Blog posts, web copy, or marketing content tailored to the client's audience.



Data Analysis

Cleaning, visualizing, and presenting data insights to support client decisions.

Submission Format

Keep your submission clean, practical, and easy to navigate. Clients and instructors should be able to scan it quickly and understand your thinking at a glance.

What to Submit



1 PDF or Slide Deck

Either format works — choose the one that shows your work most clearly.



Clear & Structured

Each section should be labeled and easy to find. Think like a professional presenting to a real client.



Practical, Not Perfect

Skip the long paragraphs. Use bullet points, short sentences, and simple tables where helpful.



Pro Tip

Think of this as a real document you'd hand to a client on Day 1. Would it give them confidence that you know what you're doing? That's your bar.



SECTION 1 OF 7

Project Scope

A clearly defined project scope is the single most important document in any freelance engagement. It sets expectations, prevents confusion, and protects both you and your client before work ever begins.

1**What You Will Deliver**

Be specific. List every deliverable by name — not just "social media posts" but "8 Instagram posts per month, static format, delivered as PNG files."

2**Quantity + Format**

Define the exact number of items, file types, and dimensions or word counts where applicable. Vague scope leads to scope creep.

3**Timeline**

Include a start date, key milestones, and final delivery date. Even a rough schedule shows the client you've thought this through.

4**Number of Revisions**

State clearly how many rounds of feedback are included (e.g., "2 rounds of revisions"). Additional rounds cost extra — and that's professional, not rude.

SECTION 2 OF 7

Simple Client Agreement

A client agreement doesn't need to be a legal document — it just needs to be **clear**. Think of it as a written handshake that protects both sides.

✓ What's Included

- All deliverables listed in the scope
- Agreed number of revision rounds
- Communication via agreed channels
- Final file delivery upon payment

✗ What's NOT Included

- Work outside the defined scope
- Rush delivery unless pre-arranged
- Additional platforms or formats
- Revisions beyond the agreed rounds

💳 Payment Terms

Specify deposit amount, due dates, and method. Example: *50% upfront, 50% on delivery.*



SECTION 3 OF 7

Client Discovery Questions

Before you start any work, you need to **understand your client's world**. These five questions help you gather the context you need to deliver work that actually hits the mark — and avoids costly misalignments later.

1

What does success look like?

Understand how the client will judge your work. Get specific — metrics, feelings, or outcomes they're hoping for.

2

Who approves the work?

Identify the decision-maker. Is it the person you're talking to, or someone else? Avoid revision loops caused by last-minute stakeholders.

3

Are there examples you love or hate?

Reference points save time. Asking for examples of work they admire — or despise — shapes your creative direction from day one.

4

What's the biggest risk?

What could cause this project to fail? Understanding their fears lets you proactively address them in your plan.

5

What are your must-have deadlines?

Find out if there are hard external deadlines — a product launch, an event — so your timeline reflects real-world constraints.



SECTION 4 OF 7

Your Project Workflow

A clear workflow shows your client — and yourself — exactly how the project will move from start to finish. Map out your process so nothing falls through the cracks.



Kickoff

Align on goals, scope, and timeline with the client



Tasks

Break the project into specific, assignable action items



Execution

Do the work according to the agreed plan and timeline



Review

Share drafts, collect feedback, and incorporate revisions



Delivery

Send final files and close out the project professionally

Each stage should have a clear owner, deliverable, and deadline. When your client can see the process, they trust you more — and interrupt you less.

SECTION 5 OF 7

Task Tracker

A task tracker makes your workflow visible and keeps you accountable. It doesn't need to be fancy — a simple three-column table or a screenshot from a tool like Trello, Notion, or even Google Sheets works perfectly.

 To Do	 In Progress	 Done
Draft content outline	Client kickoff call	Signed agreement
Send revision round 2	Design mockups (v1)	Received 50% deposit
Final delivery package	Feedback incorporated	Discovery questions sent

-  Include a screenshot or table from your actual tracker in your submission. This shows you have a real system — not just a plan on paper.

SECTION 6 OF 7

Communication Plan

Clients don't lose confidence because of slow work — they lose it because of **silence**. A communication plan tells your client exactly when to expect updates and how to reach you, eliminating anxiety before it starts.



How Often

Set a regular check-in cadence.
Example: brief updates every Monday,
and a formal progress report mid-
project.



Where

Specify your communication
channels upfront — Email for formal
updates, WhatsApp or Slack for quick
questions. One channel per purpose.



Response Time

Commit to a realistic response
window. Example: *"I respond to
messages within 24 hours on
business days."* Then stick to it.

SECTION 7 OF 7

Handling Scope Creep

Scope creep is when a client starts adding requests beyond what was originally agreed — a new page, an extra round of edits, a "quick" task that isn't so quick. It's one of the most common challenges freelancers face, and your response needs to be both **professional and firm**.

Why It Matters

Without a clear response strategy, scope creep quietly erodes your time, your rates, and your boundaries. Addressing it confidently is a sign of professionalism — not inflexibility.

The Principle

Acknowledge the request positively, then redirect to the process. Never just say "no" — offer a path forward that respects both parties.

Your Script

"That's a great addition — I can see how it would help. It does fall outside our current project scope, so I'll put together an updated cost estimate and revised timeline for your review. Does that work for you?"

Customize this script for your service area and practice saying it out loud before your first client call.

What We're Looking For

This assignment isn't about producing a flawless portfolio — it's about demonstrating that you **think like a professional**. Here's what will earn you full credit:

✓ Clear Structure

All 7 sections present, clearly labeled, and easy to navigate. A reader should find any section in under 10 seconds.

✓ Professional Thinking

Your language, boundaries, and process should reflect someone a real client would trust to manage their project.

✓ Client Management Ability

Show that you've thought through the full client experience — not just the work itself, but the communication, boundaries, and handoff.

✓ Clarity Over Perfection

We're not grading design skills or writing polish. We're looking for clear thinking and a practical system you could actually use.